

Lesson 11:

Anchors in Surah Ya-Sin

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Anchors are words and themes that are related to each other in unexpected places and in different contexts in the Quran. These anchors require making a connection between seemingly unrelated ideas.

Case Study: Surah Ya-Sin

- Background Information:
 - There was a nation to which Allah sent three messengers at the same time to call them to Islam. The people disregarded them and thought of them as a bad omen and a curse.
 - Then Allah describes a fourth person who was not a messenger. He came running from another town from the other end of the city.
 - Allah dedicates 11 ayat to what this man says to the people.
 - What's peculiar about this story is that three messengers were calling to Islam but Allah only dedicated a couple of ayat to them, but when this man spoke, his speech was the longest part of the story.
 - You would think that when there's a messenger present, his followers should be quiet because the messenger is more qualified to speak. But Allah focuses more on that man's speech than on the messengers.
 - This teaches us that each one of us has their responsibility and they avoid it just because there might be someone more qualified.
 - The notion that, if there are better people in the community to call and inform people about Islam then you don't have to do it, is completely shattered by this story.
 - Someone else being available and someone else being more qualified are not excuses to shirk our responsibility of spreading the word of Allah.
- The story is finished in the Surah and now Allah switches the topic to signs of the creations (starting from ayah 33)
- There's a particular ayah that uses the word **يَنْبَغِي**

وَالشَّمْسُ تَجْرِي لِمُسْتَقَرٍّ لَهَا ۚ ذَٰلِكَ تَقْدِيرُ الْعَزِيزِ الْعَلِيمِ ﴿٣٨﴾
وَالْقَمَرَ قَدَرْنَا مَنَازِلَ ۚ حَتَّىٰ غَادَ كَالْعُرْجُونِ الْقَدِيمِ ﴿٣٩﴾
لَا الشَّمْسُ يَنْبَغِي لَهَا أَنْ تُدْرِكَ الْقَمَرَ وَلَا اللَّيْلُ سَابِقُ النَّهَارِ ۚ وَكُلٌّ فِي فَلَكٍ يَسْبَحُونَ ﴿٤٠﴾

the lamp that illuminated his followers. So we are to the Prophet (PBUH) what the moon is to the sun.

- When the sun is up, it's brilliant, but eventually the sun sets, and when it goes away there's darkness. The one thing left is the moon; it's not quite like the lamp the way the sun is, but it's still a lamp.
- In the absence of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) the only reflection of him left in the world will be his followers. We are a glimpse of the Prophet (PBUH) to the world.

Connection #3:

- The sun doesn't necessarily have phases, but the moon does. It has the full moon when it's brilliant and then it starts weakening and weakening to the point where you can hardly see it, and then it starts strengthening again and it's back to a full moon again and so on.
- The ummah, just like the believer, will go through phases. At one point it will be strong and the next time you see it, it will be at its lowest point.

So by this tiny anchor **يُنَبِّغِي**, many profound lessons are taught.